entities have different authorities to register them; most do not. Proprietorship concerns, which a majority of MSMEs effectively are in the legal sense, are not registered by anyone as a business entity, though their shops (where applicable) are registered by labour department officials in most states. Partnerships are voluntarily registered in a Register of Firms by designated state government authorities; mostly cooperative departments are assigned this responsibility though partnerships are not cooperative enterprises. Registration of partnership firms is not mandatory and most partnership firms do not register. Societies are registered by the Registrar of Societies, and so on. All these registers are disjointed and usually maintained manually.

No authority in India really recognizes MSMEs. There is no national business register of unincorporated MSMEs in India. The Udyog Aadhaar Number (UAN) assigned by the MSME Ministry from 2015 to MSMEs on a voluntary basis is good for nothing. The architecture of the UAN scheme is also fundamentally flawed. It essentially assigns an enterprise number to an individual, not to the business. UAN is based on the individual's Aadhaar ID.

MSMEs are large in number but small in scale of business. These businesses are everywhere but the existence of most of them is not recognized formally as they do not have a business identity. They are publicly lauded for the value of their services to society, but their own cause is not served in a worthy manner. Micro businesses, in fact, are *vyavsaik anaath*, or business orphans.

Policy Assumes Small Business is Inherently Weak

The MSME policy has evolved in India with the objective of promoting SSI to serve the goal of the socialist pattern of society. Large private industry was viewed as bad from the standpoint of a socialist society whereas small private industry furthered the notion of the socialist pattern of society. Very